

Hobbies and interests

Hobbies improve self-confidence, create new experiences, and often involve meeting new people. They also relax the body and engage the mind. Most importantly, they should be fun.

SEE ALSO

◀ 74–75 Exercise

◀ 86–87 Confidence and self-esteem

◀ 102–103 School life

Getting a job

122–123 ▶

Choosing hobbies

People usually choose a hobby based on what's important to them. Some people choose a hobby that will help them develop a skill, others because they are curious about a particular topic. The best advice for anyone looking to develop a new interest is to take time to try out new things. The teen years are a perfect time to explore and experiment.



△ Be led by what you enjoy

Teens should think about what they enjoy or what interests them. It could be something from childhood, or totally new. An enjoyable hobby is an easy one to keep up.

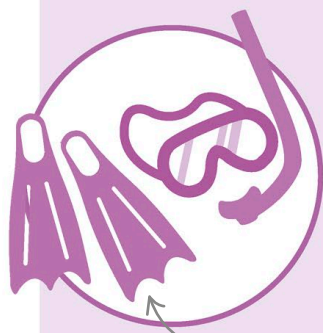


△ Ask others

When teens think they might like to try something, it's a good idea to talk to people who already do that activity to find out what it's like and what time commitment is involved.

A world of hobbies

While there are seemingly endless ways of spending free time, many hobbies can be grouped together into similar activities that might appeal—for example, a tennis player is likely to find other sports enjoyable. This may be of help when looking for a new hobby.



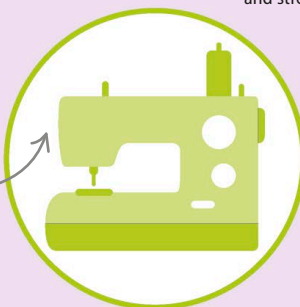
Watersports

Swimming, scuba-diving, and snorkeling can be tried out in a local pool.



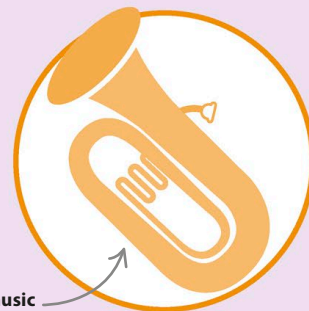
Getting crafty

Sewing, crocheting, knitting, and other crafts encourage creativity and boost concentration.



Creative streak

Writing, painting, drawing, and doodling allow people to express themselves creatively.



Making music

Playing an instrument, singing in a choir, or composing songs develop creativity.

Fighting shape

Sports such as boxing build coordination and strength.

